

Cybersecurity Quick Reference

A fast-scan guide to red-flag signs, response steps, and daily habits

Spot the Warning Signs

Sign	What It Usually Means
Urgent or threatening tone	Pressure tactic used in phishing to stop you from thinking it through
Unexpected attachment	Possible malware delivery, especially .exe, .zip, or macro files
Mismatched sender address	Spoofed identity impersonating a trusted contact or brand
Link text doesn't match URL	Hidden redirect to a malicious site
Request for credentials via email	Legitimate services rarely ask you to confirm a password by email
Unfamiliar login alert	Possible account compromise — check activity immediately

Risk Level Legend

Critical	Immediate action required — potential for major data loss or system-wide compromise
High	Prioritize remediation soon — significant potential impact
Medium / Low	Address as part of routine security maintenance

If You Think You've Been Compromised

- 1 Disconnect the device from the network (Wi-Fi/Ethernet) to limit spread
- 2 Do not shut down the device if forensic evidence may be needed — consult IT/security first
- 3 Change passwords for critical accounts from a separate, trusted device
- 4 Enable or verify multi-factor authentication on affected accounts
- 5 Report the incident to your IT/security team or, for personal accounts, the service provider
- 6 Run a full antivirus/anti-malware scan once isolated
- 7 Restore from a known-clean backup if files were encrypted or corrupted

Daily Habits That Matter Most

- Use a password manager and unique passwords per account
- Turn on multi-factor authentication everywhere it's offered

- Install updates promptly instead of postponing them
- Pause before clicking — hover links, verify senders
- Back up important files on a regular, automatic schedule

This quick-reference sheet complements the full Cybersecurity Awareness Report and is intended for fast, at-a-glance use.